

Photo Essay Building the

Kachemak

V-Bottom Dory



Plans available at:

<http://SpiralInternational.com>

Building the Kachemak V-Bottom Dory



As with all Spira International boats, you begin by building the frames. These may be built from construction grade lumber, or you can upgrade to better materials. Standard milled dimensional lumber, in this case 2x4s (1-1/2" x 3-1/2") studs. Optionally you may use 5/4

thickness lumber (full 1" thick) for any of the 2x called out. These are not as available as the 1-1/2" thick stock, but in some parts of the country they are quite available. If you are building it where metric sized materials are available, the 35x90 standard lumber is used.



Next the strongback is built. This is simply a sturdy beam on which you will frame your boat. The strongback supports everything upside down until you have the hull structure completed. Then it is removed.

You then set up the frames on the strongback. The floor timbers (horizontal members spanning the bottoms of the frames) are designed so that they sit right on the strongback. There is no



blocking up of the frames that is often needed on flat bottom boat designs, especially those with rocker. Positioning the frames is much simpler with a v-bottom boat when designed in this manner.



The frames are then notched to receive the keelson, right down the center line of the hull.



Next the chine logs and shear clamps are notched into place. The construction manual gives insight into how to easily make these cuts so that the longitudinal elements bend into place properly.

The next step is referred to as fairing. This process ensures that the frame elements offer a flat surface for the planking to fit against. This gives a strong glue joint when the planking is put into place. This is accomplished with a drawknife, plane, sander or other creative methods.





Next comes the planking . It is leaned against the framing to use the framing as a pattern to cut out the plywood .

Up near the bow, on the bottom, the planking must be cut into strips as it is generally too stiff to make the required twist:



Once the screw holes and minor cracks are filled, two layers of fiberglass cloth are applied to the hull to strengthen and seal it using epoxy resin:



Now you sand, sand and sand some more. Not the most fun thing, but if you can convince your kids it's fun, you're home free:



Now, you can paint if you wish – It's easier when it's upside down, then gather up the neighbors and friends for a boat flipping party:



OK, now it's time to finish out the inside. With the Kachemak, you can add slatted or a solid self-bailing deck, a center console or even a light pilothouse if you wish, or just go with simple thwart seats.



And when you're done, it should look something like this:



Now – Go fishing!